8.2.1 Natural Disaster

A Natural Disaster is a major adverse event that is caused by the natural forces of the earth where great damage and some times loss of life occurs.

The following are the examples of natural disaster.

- Cyclone
- Earthquake
- Flood
- Tsunami
- Landslide
- Volcanic eruption

Among these cyclone, earthquake and flood are frequently happening disasters in India.

8.2.2 Man-Made Disaster

The developmental activities of the human being through improper intervention with nature have also increased the degree of occurrence of natural disasters in many folds. This mainly involves situations in which civilian populations suffer casualties, losses of property, basic services and means of livelihood as a result of war, civil strife or other conflicts.

The following few types of disasters are explained in detail in this chapter:

8.3 Earthquake

An earthquake is a trembling or shaking movement of the earth's surface, resulting from plate movements along a fault-plane or as a result of volcanic activity.

The location at which the seismic waves started propagating from the deep subsurface is known as Focus. The spot on the earth surface just above the Focus is known as Epicentre. Earthquakes can strike suddenly, violently and without warning at any time of the day or night.

Earthquake magnitude is a measure of the "size" or amplitude, of the seismic waves generated by an earthquake source and recorded by seismographs. Richter scale is commonly used today to measure the magnitude of earthquake.



In 2001 Gujarat earthquake also known as the Bhuj earthquake is one of the vulnerable earthquake occurred in India. It occurred on 26th January India's 52nd Republic Day at 8.46 AM IST and lasted for over two minutes at a magnitude of 7.7 Richter. The epicentre was about 9 km south – west of the village of Chobari in Bhachau taluk of Kutch district.



8.3.1 Causes of Earth quake

- Seismic Waves
- Compression in the earth's crust
- Groundwater extraction
- Geothermal drilling
- Tectonic movements of the earth
- Volcanic eruptions

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